



Employee Handbook

January 2026

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Welcome to Semantic Arts!

We are pleased to have you on the team. It is our hope that this handbook provides a fairly comprehensive look at who we are as a company, and some basic guidelines to follow. We strive to create and maintain a work environment that is both productive and enjoyable. This is a living document, so please refer back often and feel free to share any ideas you might have to make it better. Should you have any questions or concerns, reach out to the office team at office@semanticarts.com.

Vision & Mission

The vision of Semantic arts is a world where enterprise information is widely understood and easily accessed by all who have permission. Most companies solve their information systems problems by implementing application systems (payroll, inventory, customer relations, etc.). By the time firms get very large, they have thousands of these application systems. Each is its own data silo. Putting Humpty Dumpty back together consumes most of the IT resources of most medium to large firms. Semantic Arts helps clients reverse this process, by focusing first on designing a single simple core data model. Then we help clients migrate data and functionality to this core model.

Our mission then is to lead as many firms as possible on their journey to a data-centric future.

Values

Since 2000, we have focused singularly on this mission. We have assembled what might be the largest team in the world of professionals focused solely on this, and have built methodology, tools, and quality assurance processes to make sure we continue to deliver the highest possible quality outcomes. Along the way, we have developed the following core values:

Create Value: all our projects should be creating value for our clients. We are not trying to set up situations where our clients pay us because we have coerced them or made them dependent on us.

One Voice: We can disagree violently in the office but will present our best consensus when we are with the client.

Share Equitably: We focus on ways to share the results of our efforts with our clients, our partners, and our employees. Equitable sharing is based on contribution.

Lifetime Learning: We value continual study and research to look for better ways, and to stay current in our discipline, rather than milking whatever expertise we have.

Show Respect: While focusing on results we need to remain mindful of the contribution, options, and rights of others. In all our dealings we need to be humble.

Have Fun: We are not here to suffer for the sake of the firm. We can accomplish all we set out to, stay true to our values, still have a good time, and take time off to enjoy our outside lives.

Principles of Employment

Diversity, Equity & Inclusion Statement

At Semantic Arts a diverse, inclusive, and equitable workplace is one where all employees feel valued and respected. We are committed to providing equal opportunity for employment and advancement in all areas of the company. We respect and value diverse life experiences and heritages and ensure that all voices are valued and heard.

Diversity is not about a particular person, but the uniqueness of those individuals creating a diverse group. Diversity strengthens the collective and provides perspective and input that would otherwise be lost.

For that diversity to bring value, our culture must also be inclusive. That each person would feel welcomed and valued, and comfortable sharing those unique perspectives. We commit to cultivating a setting in which all people feel valued and have opportunities to grow.

Along with diversity and inclusion, the company values equitable sharing. Principles of equity can be found within our pay structure, training and learning budget, and coaching framework. We are committed to ensuring all employees have access to the same opportunities to develop and receive support for continuous learning and growth.

Please watch the recording of a training session Carey Mason did with us: it is [available at this link](#).

Equal Employment Opportunity

Semantic Arts is an Equal Opportunity Employer that does not discriminate on the basis of actual or perceived race, color, religious creed, national origin, ancestry, citizenship status, age, sex or gender (including pregnancy, childbirth, and related medical conditions), gender identity or expression (including transgender status), sexual orientation, marital status, familial status, military service and veteran status, physical or mental disability, protected medical condition as defined by applicable state or local law (such as cancer or atypical hereditary cellular or blood trait), reproductive health decision making, genetic information, public assistance, local human rights commission activity, or any other characteristic protected by applicable federal, state, or local laws and ordinances. Semantic Arts'

management team is dedicated to this policy with respect to recruitment, hiring, placement, promotion, transfer, training, compensation, benefits, employee activities, access to facilities and programs, and general treatment during employment.

The Company will endeavor to make a reasonable accommodation of an otherwise qualified applicant or employee related to an individual's: physical or mental disability; sincerely held religious beliefs and practices; needs as a victim of domestic violence, sex offenses, or stalking; needs related to pregnancy, childbirth, or related medical conditions; and/or any other reason required by applicable law, unless doing so would impose an undue hardship upon the Company's business operations. Any applicant or employee who needs an accommodation to perform the essential functions of the job should contact Human Resources to request such an accommodation. The individual should specify what accommodation is needed to perform the job and submit supporting documentation explaining the basis for the requested accommodation, to the extent permitted and in accordance with applicable law. The Company will review and analyze the request, including engaging in an interactive process with the employee or applicant, to identify if such an accommodation can be made. The Company will evaluate requested accommodations, and as appropriate identify other possible accommodations, if any. The individual will be notified of the Company's decision within a reasonable period. The Company treats all medical information submitted as part of the accommodation process in a confidential manner.

Any employees with questions or concerns about equal employment opportunities in the workplace are encouraged to bring these issues to the attention of Human Resources. The Company will not allow any form of retaliation against individuals who raise issues of equal employment opportunity. If employees feel they have been subjected to any such retaliation, they should contact Human Resources. To ensure our workplace is free of artificial barriers, violation of this policy including any improper retaliatory conduct will lead to discipline, up to and including discharge. All employees must cooperate with all investigations conducted pursuant to this policy.

Discrimination, Harassment, and Retaliation Prevention

Semantic Arts does not tolerate and prohibits discrimination, harassment, or retaliation of or against job applicants, contractors, interns, volunteers, or employees by another employee, supervisor, vendor, customer or third party based on actual or perceived race, color, religious creed, national origin, ancestry, citizenship status, age, sex or gender (including pregnancy, childbirth, and related medical conditions), gender identity or expression (including transgender status), sexual orientation, marital status, familial status, military service and veteran status, physical or mental disability, protected medical condition as defined by applicable state or local law (such as cancer or atypical hereditary cellular or blood trait), reproductive health decision making, genetic information, public assistance, local human rights commission activity, or any other characteristic protected by applicable federal, state, or local laws and ordinances. Further, the Company prohibits

discrimination, harassment, and retaliation on the basis of any combination of protected characteristics. The Company is committed to a workplace free of discrimination, harassment, and retaliation.

The Company management team is dedicated to ensuring the fulfillment of this policy as it applies to all terms and conditions of employment, including recruitment, hiring, placement, promotion, transfer, training, compensation, benefits, employee activities, and general treatment during employment.

Discrimination Defined

Discrimination under this policy means treating differently or denying or granting a benefit to an individual because of the individual's protected characteristic.

Harassment Defined

Harassment is defined in this policy as unwelcome verbal, visual, or physical conduct creating an intimidating, an offensive, or a hostile work environment that interferes with work performance. Harassment can be verbal (including slurs, jokes, insults, epithets, gestures, or teasing), visual (including offensive posters, symbols, cartoons, drawings, computer displays, text messages, social media, or emails), or physical conduct (including physically threatening another, blocking someone's way, etc.) that denigrates or shows hostility or aversion toward an individual because of any protected characteristic. Such conduct violates this policy, even if it is not unlawful. Because it is difficult to define unlawful harassment, employees are expected to behave at all times in a manner consistent with the intended purpose of this policy.

Sexual Harassment Defined

Sexual harassment can include all the above actions, as well as other unwelcome conduct, such as unwelcome or unsolicited sexual advances, requests for sexual favors, conversations regarding sexual activities, and other verbal or physical conduct of a sexual nature. Sexual harassment includes unwelcome or unwanted conduct that is either of a sexual nature or directed at an individual because of that individual's sex when:

- Submission to that conduct or to those advances or requests is made either explicitly or implicitly a term or condition of an individual's employment;
- Submission to or rejection of the conduct or advances or requests by an individual is used as the basis for employment decisions affecting the individual; or
- The conduct or advances or requests have the purpose or effect of unreasonably interfering with an individual's work performance or creating an intimidating, hostile, or offensive working environment.

Examples of conduct that violate this policy include:

- Unwelcome or unwanted sexual advances, flirtations, advances, leering, whistling, touching, pinching, assault, and blocking normal movement;
- Requests for sexual favors or demands for sexual favors in exchange for favorable treatment;
- Obscene or vulgar gestures, posters, or comments;
- Sexual jokes or comments about a person's body, sexual prowess, or sexual deficiencies;
- Propositions or suggestive or insulting comments of a sexual nature;
- Derogatory cartoons, posters, and drawings;
- Sexually explicit emails, text messages, or voicemails;
- Uninvited touching of a sexual nature;
- Unwelcome or unwanted sexually related comments;
- Conversation about one's own or someone else's sex life;
- Conduct or comments consistently targeted at only one (1) gender, even if the content is not sexual; and
- Teasing or other conduct directed toward a person because of the person's gender.
- Interfering with, destroying, or damaging a person's workstation, tools, or equipment, or otherwise interfering with the individual's ability to perform the job;
- Sabotaging an individual's work;
- Bullying, yelling, or name-calling;

This list is just a sample of behaviors and should not be considered exhaustive. Any employee or covered individual who believes they have experienced sexual harassment, even if it does not appear on this list, should feel encouraged to report it. In addition, sexual harassment is not limited to interactions in person. Sexual harassment can occur when employees are working remotely from home as well. Harassment can happen on virtual meeting platforms, in messaging apps, and during non-working hours, and regardless of whether the communication occurs on Semantic Arts-owned or personal devices.

Sexual Assault Defined

Sexual assault, defined as unwanted conduct of a sexual nature that is inflicted upon a person or compelled through the use of physical force, manipulation, threat, or intimidation, is also specifically prohibited.

Any discrimination, harassment, or retaliation is unacceptable in the workplace and in any work-related settings such as business trips and business-related social functions, regardless of whether the conduct is engaged in by a supervisor, coworker, client, customer, vendor, or other third party.

Anti-Bullying Policy

The Company is committed to a culture and work environment free from all forms of abusive conduct, or bullying. Defined as conduct of an employer or employee in the workplace that, with malice, a reasonable person would find hostile, offensive, and unrelated to an employer's legitimate business interests. Some examples could include (but are not limited to):

- Verbal remarks that are derogatory, insulting, threatening, intimidating or humiliating
- Belittling or disregarding opinions
- Excessive supervision
- Unfairly blaming for mistakes
- Trivializing of work and achievements
- Spreading rumor or innuendo
- Deliberate exclusion
- Practical jokes
- Name calling

These actions may be intentional or unintentional, but intention is not important. We encourage all employees to report instances of these behaviors. They will be investigated and necessary actions taken in accordance with the Company's complaint procedures.

Definition of Retaliation

Retaliation is prohibited. No employee or covered individual should fear reporting sexual harassment if they believe it has occurred. Retaliation means adverse conduct taken because an individual reported an actual or perceived violation of this policy, opposed practices prohibited by this policy, or participated in the reporting and investigation process described below. Examples of retaliation may include but are not limited to:

- Demotion, termination, denying accommodations, reduced hours, or the assignment of less desirable shifts;
- Publicly releasing personnel files;
- Refusing to provide a reference in a manner consistent with Semantic Arts policy or practice or providing an unwarranted negative reference;
- Labeling the employee as "difficult" and excluding them from projects to avoid "drama;"
- Undermining an individual's immigration status;
- Reducing work responsibilities, passing over for a promotion, or moving an individual's desk to a less desirable office location;
- Threats of physical violence outside of work hours; and
- Disparaging someone on social media.

Supervisory Responsibilities. Everyone must work toward preventing sexual harassment, but supervisors and managers have a special responsibility to prevent sexual harassment and discrimination. Every supervisor who learns of any employee's concern about conduct in violation of this policy, whether in a formal complaint or informally, or who otherwise is aware of conduct in violation of this policy, must immediately report the issues raised or conduct to human resources. Managers and supervisors should not be passive and wait for employees to make a claim of harassment. If they observe such behavior, they must act.

While supervisors and managers have a responsibility to report harassment and discrimination, supervisors and managers must be mindful of the impact that harassment and a subsequent investigation have on victims. Being identified as a possible victim of harassment and questioned about harassment discrimination can be intimidating, uncomfortable, and re-traumatizing for individuals. Supervisors and managers must accommodate the needs of individuals who have experienced harassment to ensure workplace is safe, supportive, and free from retaliation for them during and after any investigation.

Bystander Intervention. Any employee witnessing harassment as a bystander is encouraged to report it. There are five (5) standard methods of bystander intervention that can be used when anyone witnesses harassment or discrimination and wants to help:

- A bystander can interrupt the harassment by engaging with the individual being harassed and distracting them from the harassing behavior;
- A bystander who feels unsafe interrupting on their own can ask a third party to help intervene in the harassment;
- A bystander can record or take notes on the harassment incident to benefit a future investigation;
- A bystander might check in with the person who has been harassed after the incident, see how they are feeling, and let them know the behavior was not acceptable; and
- If a bystander feels safe, they can confront the harassers and name the behavior as inappropriate. When confronting harassment, physically assaulting an individual is never an appropriate response.

Though not exhaustive and dependent on the circumstances, the guidelines above can serve as a brief guide of how to react when witnessing harassment in the workplace. Any employee witnessing harassment as a bystander is encouraged to report it. A supervisor or manager that is a bystander to harassment is required to report it.

All discrimination, harassment, and retaliation is unacceptable in the workplace and in any work-related settings such as business trips and business-related social functions, regardless of whether the conduct is engaged in by a supervisor, a coworker, a client, a customer, a vendor, or another third party.

Reporting Procedures

The following steps have been put into place to ensure the work environment is respectful, professional, and free of discrimination, harassment, and retaliation. If the employee believes someone has violated this policy or the Equal Employment Opportunity Policy, the employee should promptly bring the matter to the immediate attention of Human Resources. If this individual is the person toward whom the complaint is directed, the employee should contact the President. If the employee makes a complaint under this policy and has not received a satisfactory response within five (5) business days, the President should be contacted immediately.

This policy is aimed at providing employees and covered individuals an understanding of their right to a discrimination and harassment free workplace. All employees should feel safe at work. Though the focus of this policy is on sexual harassment and gender discrimination, the HRL protects against discrimination in several protected classes including sex, sexual orientation, gender identity or expression, age, race, creed, color, national origin, military status, disability, pre-disposing genetic characteristics, familial status, marital status, criminal history, or domestic violence survivor status. The prevention policies outlined above should be considered applicable to all protected classes. Remember, Semantic Arts cannot remedy claimed sexual or other harassment, discrimination, or retaliation unless the employee brings these claims to the attention of management. Employees should report any conduct which they believe violates this policy.

Massachusetts - While employees are encouraged to report claims internally, if they believe they have been subjected to sexual harassment or other harassment in violation of state law, they may file a formal complaint with the government agency or agencies set forth below. Using the Company's complaint process does not prohibit the employee from filing a complaint with these agencies.

United States Equal Employment Opportunity Commission (EEOC), JFK Federal Building, Room 475, Boston, Massachusetts 02203, (617) 565-3200

The Massachusetts Commission Against Discrimination (MCAD)

Boston Office One Ashburton Place, Room 601, Boston, Massachusetts 02108, (617) 994-6000

Springfield Office: 436 Dwight Street, Room 220, Springfield, Massachusetts 01103, (413) 739-2145

New Bedford Office: 128 Union Street, Suite 206, New Bedford, Massachusetts 02740, (774) 510-5801

New York - The Human Rights Law (HRL), codified as N.Y. Exec. Law, art. 15, § 290 et seq., applies to all employers in New York State with regard to sexual harassment and protects employees paid or unpaid interns and non-employees regardless of immigration status. A

complaint alleging violation of the HRL may be filed either with the New York State Division of Human Rights (NYSDHR) or in New York State Supreme Court.

Complaints with NYSDHR may be filed any time within three (3) years of the sexual harassment or within one (1) year of any other harassment. If an individual did not file at NYSDHR, they can sue directly in state court under the HRL, within three (3) years of the alleged harassment. An individual may not file with NYSDHR if they have already filed a HRL complaint in state court.

Complaining internally to the Company does not extend the time to file with NYSDHR or in court.

An attorney is not needed to file a complaint with NYSDHR, and there is no cost to file with NYSDHR.

NYSDHR will investigate complaints and determine whether there is probable cause to believe that sexual harassment has occurred. Probable cause cases are forwarded to a public hearing before an administrative law judge. If sexual harassment is found after a hearing, NYSDHR has the power to award relief, which varies but may include requiring the employer to take action to stop the harassment, or redress the damage caused, including paying of monetary damages, attorney's fees, punitive damages, and civil fines.

The NYSDHR has established a toll-free confidential hotline to provide counsel and assistance to individuals who believe they are experiencing workplace sexual harassment. Employees can call the toll-free sexual harassment hotline at 1-800-HARASS-3 Monday through Friday, 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM.

NYSDHR's main office contact information is: NYS Division of Human Rights, One Fordham Plaza, Fourth Floor, Bronx, New York 10458; (718) 741-8400; www.dhr.ny.gov.

Employees should contact NYSDHR at (888) 392-3644 or visit dhr.ny.gov/complaint for more information about filing a complaint. The website has a digital complaint process that can be completed on your computer or mobile device from start to finish. The website also has a complaint form that can be downloaded, filled out, notarized, and mailed to NYSDHR. The website also contains contact information for NYSDHR's regional offices across New York State.

Local Protections

Many localities enforce laws protecting individuals from harassment and discrimination. An individual should contact the county, city, or town in which they live to find out if such a law exists.

Local Police Department Contact

If the harassment involves unwanted physical touching, coerced physical confinement, or coerced sex acts, the conduct may constitute a crime.

Employees should contact the local police department if they wish to pursue criminal charges.

Investigation Procedures

Upon receiving a complaint, the Company will promptly conduct a fair and thorough investigation into the facts and circumstances of any claim of a violation of this policy or the Equal Employment Opportunity policy. To the extent possible, the Company will endeavor to keep the reporting employee's concerns confidential. However, complete confidentiality may not be possible in all circumstances.

During the investigation, the Company generally will interview the complainant and the accused, conduct further interviews as necessary, and review any relevant documents or other information. Upon completion of the investigation, the Company shall determine whether this policy has been violated based on its reasonable evaluation of the information gathered during the investigation. The Company will inform the complainant and the accused of the results of the investigation.

The Company will take corrective measures against any person who it finds to have engaged in conduct in violation of this policy, if the Company determines such measures are necessary. These measures may include, but are not limited to, counseling, suspension, or immediate termination. Anyone, regardless of position or title, who the Company determines has engaged in conduct that violates this policy will be subject to discipline up to and including termination.

Complaint Procedure & Open-Door Guideline

If you believe there has been a violation of the EEO policy or harassment based on the protected classes listed above, including sexual harassment, please use the following complaint procedure. The Company expects employees to make a prompt complaint to enable the Company to investigate and correct any behavior that may violate this policy.

Report the incident to Human Resources, they will investigate the matter and take corrective action. Your complaint will be kept as confidential as practicable.

The Company prohibits retaliation against an employee for filing a complaint under this policy or for assisting in a complaint investigation. If you believe there has been a violation of our EEO or retaliation standard, please follow the complaint procedure outlined above.

Sexual harassment is considered a form of employee misconduct. If the Company finds that an employee's behavior violates this policy, disciplinary action will be taken, up to and

including termination of employment. This includes any individual found to have engaged in sexual harassment, as well as any supervisory or managerial personnel who knowingly allow such behavior to continue.

Note that there are applicable federal, state, and local statutes regarding sexual harassment, remedies available to victims of sexual harassment, and penalties for anyone caught retaliating against individuals who either complain of sexual harassment or assist in any investigation or proceeding involving sexual harassment. Semantic Arts will comply with applicable statutes and report unlawful activity to the proper authorities.

The company also maintains an open-door policy regarding any work-related matters. If you have a question or concern about a work-related matter, discuss it frankly with your supervisor. Normally, this discussion should occur within three to five days of the incident, or in a timely manner. Discussions held in a timely manner will enhance our ability to answer questions and resolve concerns while they are fresh in everyone's minds.

If you are not satisfied after discussing the issue with the supervisor, or if it is inappropriate to go to the supervisor, an "open door" guideline exists. You may take your question or concern to a representative of the Human Resources Department and/or to higher levels of management. Should you desire further resolution, speak to the President who will make the final determination.

Legal Protections and External Remedies

Any employee or covered individual who prefers not to report harassment to their manager or employer may choose to pursue external legal remedies. Complaints may be made to both the employer and a government agency. Aside from the internal complaint process at the Company, individuals may choose to pursue external legal remedies with relevant governmental entities.

ADA & Religious Accommodation

Semantic Arts is committed to complying with applicable federal, state, and local laws governing reasonable accommodations of individuals, including, but not limited to, the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) and the Pregnant Workers Fairness Act (PWFA). To that end, Semantic Arts will endeavor to make a reasonable accommodation to applicants and employees who have requested an accommodation or for whom Semantic Arts has notice may require such an accommodation, related to an individual's:

- Disability, meaning any physical, medical, mental, or psychological impairment, or a history or record of such impairment;
- Sincerely held religious beliefs and practices;
- Needs as a victim of domestic violence, sex offenses, or stalking;
- Needs related to pregnancy, childbirth, or related medical conditions; and/or

- Any other reason required by applicable law, unless the accommodation would impose an undue hardship on the operation of our business.

Any employee who would like to request an accommodation based on any of the reasons set forth above should contact Human Resources. Accommodation requests can be made in writing using a form which can be obtained from Human Resources. If the employee who has requested an accommodation has not received an initial response within five (5) business days, they should contact the President.

Unless otherwise required by law, Semantic Arts may request that the employee provide supporting documentation. Cooperating with Semantic Arts by returning requested information in a timely fashion is required.

After receiving a request for an accommodation or learning indirectly that the employee may require such an accommodation, Semantic Arts will engage in an interactive dialogue with the employee.

Even if the employee has not formally requested an accommodation, Semantic Arts may initiate an interactive dialogue under certain circumstances, such as when Semantic Arts has knowledge that employee's performance at work has been negatively affected and a reasonable basis to believe that the issue is related to any of the protected classifications set forth above, in compliance with applicable law. In the event Semantic Arts initiates an interactive dialogue, it should not be construed as Semantic Arts' belief the employee requires an accommodation but will serve as an invitation for the employee to share with Semantic Arts any information the employee desires to share, or to request an accommodation.

The interactive dialogue may take place in person, by telephone, or by electronic means. As part of the interactive dialogue, Semantic Arts will communicate openly and in good faith with the employee in a timely manner to determine whether and how Semantic Arts may be able to provide a reasonable accommodation. To the extent necessary and appropriate based on the request, Semantic Arts will attempt to explore the existence and feasibility of alternative accommodations as well as alternative positions for the employee. Semantic Arts is not required to provide the specific accommodation sought by the employee, provided the alternatives are reasonable and either meet the specific needs of the employee or specifically address the employee's limitations.

Semantic Arts will endeavor to keep confidential all communications regarding requests for reasonable accommodations and all circumstances surrounding the employee's underlying reason for needing an accommodation.

Semantic Arts will not allow any form of retaliation against employees who have requested an accommodation, for whom Semantic Arts has notice may require such an accommodation, or who otherwise engage in the interactive dialogue process.

Employees with questions regarding this policy should contact Human Resources.

Parental/Pregnancy Accommodation

Semantic Arts will not discriminate against employees because of pregnancy, childbirth, or related conditions. If employees request reasonable accommodation due to health conditions related to pregnancy or the physical recovery from childbirth, the Company will endeavor to provide a reasonable accommodation to enable applicants and employees to perform the essential functions of the job, unless the accommodation would impose an undue hardship on the operation of the business. The Company will engage in a timely, good faith, and interactive process with the employee to determine effective, reasonable accommodations for conditions related to pregnancy, physical recovery from childbirth, or a related condition.

Reasonable accommodations may include, but are not limited to more frequent or longer break periods; more frequent restroom, food, and water breaks; acquisition or modification of equipment or seating; limitations on lifting; temporary transfer to a less strenuous or hazardous position if available, with return to the current position after pregnancy; job restructuring; or modified work schedules.

The Company will not require employees affected by pregnancy, physical recovery from childbirth, or a related condition to accept an accommodation that they choose not to accept if they did not request an accommodation or if the accommodation is not necessary for the employees to perform the essential functions of the job, nor will the Company require a pregnant employee to take leave if another reasonable accommodation is available which will permit the employee to continue working.

The Company reserves the right to require employees to provide a note stating the necessity of a reasonable accommodation from a licensed health care provider before providing a reasonable accommodation.

The Company will not take adverse action against pregnant employees who request or use a reasonable accommodation related to pregnancy, physical recovery from childbirth, or a related condition. The Company will not deny employment opportunities to employees based on the need to make a reasonable accommodation related to pregnancy, physical recovery from childbirth, or a related condition.

If employees have any questions about this policy or would like to request a reasonable accommodation, they should contact Human Resources.

Lactation Accommodations

Semantic Arts will provide a reasonable amount of break time to accommodate employees desiring to express breast milk for their child, in accordance with and to the extent required

by applicable law. The break time, if possible and permitted by applicable law, must run concurrently with rest and meal periods already provided. If the break time does not run concurrently with rest and meal periods already provided, the break time will be unpaid, subject to applicable law.

The Company may not be able to provide additional break time if doing so would seriously disrupt the Company's operations, subject to applicable law.

The Company will make reasonable efforts to provide employees with the use of a room or location in close proximity to the employee's work area, other than a bathroom, to express milk in private. This location may be the employee's private office, if applicable. Please consult Human Resources with questions regarding this policy.

Employees should advise management if they need break time and an area for this purpose. Employees will not be discriminated against or retaliated against for exercising their rights under this policy.

Alcohol And Drugs

In compliance with the Drug-Free Workplace Act of 1988, the Company is committed to providing a safe and productive work environment. Alcohol and drug misuse poses a threat to the health and safety of the Company employees. Further, alert and rational behavior are required for the safe and adequate performance of job duties.

Therefore, whenever employees are working (on or off site) or conducting company-related work, they are prohibited from using, possessing, buying, selling, manufacturing or dispensing an illegal drug (as defined by federal law), or from being intoxicated due to over-consumption of alcohol.

"Illegal drug" means a substance whose use or possession is controlled by federal law but that is not being used or possessed under the supervision of a licensed health care professional. (Controlled substances are listed in Schedules I-V of 21 C.F.R. Part 1308.)

Employees are subject to testing either based on reasonable suspicion by at least two other employees, or if they have caused or contributed to an accident where there is a reasonable suspicion that drugs or alcohol were involved. Testing will be performed by a certified testing facility subject to direction of management and HR. Refusal to test or a positive result following testing could result in immediate termination.

The Company's Employee Assistance Program is available as a resource to support employees seeking help for drug or alcohol addiction. Review the current benefit book found in SharePoint for more information on services offered and how to get in touch. Note that any and all discussions related to drug or alcohol use will be held in the highest confidence according to applicable laws.

Smoking (or vaping) of any kind is prohibited within all areas of the workplace including within 15 feet of entrances. This includes when working on-site with a client.

Workplace Violence

Semantic Arts is strongly committed to providing a safe workplace. The purpose of this policy is to minimize the risk of personal injury to employees and damage to Company and personal property.

Semantic Arts does not expect employees to become experts in psychology or to physically subdue a threatening or violent individual. Indeed, Semantic Arts specifically discourages employees from engaging in any physical confrontation with a violent or potentially violent individual. However, Semantic Arts does expect and encourage employees to exercise reasonable judgment in identifying potentially dangerous situations.

Experts in the mental health profession state that prior to engaging in acts of violence, troubled individuals often exhibit one or more of the following behaviors or signs: over-resentment, anger and hostility; extreme agitation; making ominous threats such as bad things will happen to a particular person, or a catastrophic event will occur; sudden and significant decline in work performance; irresponsible, irrational, intimidating, aggressive or otherwise inappropriate behavior; reacting to questions with an antagonistic or overtly negative attitude; discussing weapons and their use, and/or brandishing weapons in the workplace; overreacting or reacting harshly to changes in Company policies and procedures; personality conflicts with co-workers; obsession or preoccupation with a co-worker or supervisor; attempts to sabotage the work or equipment of a co-worker; blaming others for mistakes and circumstances; or demonstrating a propensity to behave and react irrationally.

Prohibited Conduct

Threats, threatening language or any other acts of aggression or violence made toward or by any Company employee WILL NOT BE TOLERATED. For purposes of this policy, a threat includes any verbal or physical harassment or abuse, any attempt at intimidating or instilling fear in others, menacing gestures, flashing of weapons, stalking or any other hostile, aggressive, injurious or destructive action undertaken for the purpose of domination or intimidation.

Procedures for Reporting a Threat

All potentially dangerous situations, including threats by co-workers, should be reported immediately to any member of management with whom the employee feels comfortable. If you believe the threat to be imminent, call 911 and follow instructions given. Reports of threats may be maintained confidential to the extent maintaining confidentiality does not

impede Semantic Arts' ability to investigate and respond to the complaints. All threats will be promptly investigated. All employees must cooperate with all investigations. No employee will be subjected to retaliation, intimidation or disciplinary action as a result of reporting a threat in good faith under this policy.

If the Company determines, after an appropriate good faith investigation, that someone has violated this policy, the Company will take swift and appropriate corrective action.

If the employee is the recipient of a threat made by an outside party, that employee should follow the steps detailed in this section. It is important for the Company to be aware of any potential danger in its offices. Indeed, the Company wants to take effective measures to protect everyone from the threat of a violent act by employees or by anyone else.

Operational Policies

Employee Classifications

Employees of the Company are classified as either exempt or nonexempt under federal and state wage and hour laws and are further classified for administrative purposes, such as the administration of certain benefits. The following classifications are used throughout this section.

Full-time Employee - an employee normally scheduled to work at least 30 hours per week. Full-time employees are eligible for the employee benefits described in this Handbook and are provided with benefits required by applicable law

Part-time Employee - an employee normally scheduled to work less than 30 hours per week. Part-time employees are eligible for some, but not all employee benefits described in this Handbook and are provided with benefits required by applicable law.

Temporary Employee - employees who are employed for short-term assignments. Temporary employees are hired to temporarily supplement the workforce or assist in the completion of a specific project. These temporary employment assignments are of limited duration. Temporary employees are not eligible for employee benefits, except as required by applicable law and may be classified as exempt or nonexempt based on job duties and compensation.

Exempt Employee - Exempt employees are employees whose job assignments meet specific tests established by the federal Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA) and state law and who are exempt from minimum wage and/or overtime pay requirements.

Non-exempt Employee – Nonexempt employees are employees whose job positions do not meet FLSA or applicable state exemption tests, and who are not exempt from minimum wage and overtime pay requirements. Nonexempt employees are eligible to receive overtime pay for hours worked more than 40 hours in each workweek, or as otherwise required by applicable state law.

Personnel Files and Records

In order to obtain their position, employees have provided personal information, such as address and telephone number. This information is contained in their personnel file.

Employees should keep their personnel file up to date by informing Human Resources of any changes. Unreported changes of address, marital status, etc. can affect withholding tax and benefit coverage. Further, an "out of date" emergency contact or an inability to reach employees in a crisis could cause a severe health or safety risk or other significant problem.

In accordance with CO Revised Statute 8-2-129, employees have the right to request once annually a copy of his or her own personnel file. A former employee may make one inspection request after termination of their employment. Records available are limited in scope per statute. The Company has 30 days from formal request to make said records available.

Flexible & Remote Work Policy

We trust that our employees are providing excellent service to both internal and external stakeholders. That culture of trust is seen in the fact our employees work remotely from anywhere, allowing work from home, work while traveling, and the ability to be present where and when needed.

As an employee of the company, much of your time will be spent in a remote setting. Employees are free to generally set their schedule in a way that is conducive to this arrangement, with some basic guidelines:

- Regular attendance is considered an essential function of each employee's job and is necessary for the efficient operation of the business
- Employees are expected to attend all scheduled meetings with colleagues and/or clients unless taking paid time off. Absences or late arrivals should be communicated to those involved as often as possible. Though there are times this is not feasible, it should be the exception and not the norm.

You are expected to take virtual meetings, including internal meetings, with your computer camera turned on and as distraction-free as possible (this includes backgrounds,

workspaces, headphones, etc). Though remote, the goal is to attempt to capture the value face-to-face interaction provides.

Pay Period

Our pay periods start at 2:01 a.m. MT on Fridays and ends at 2:00 a.m. MT on the Friday, 28 days later (four week pay period).

Paydays

Paydays are every four (4) weeks. Employees should set up their banking information via Rippling. Do not ever give your banking details out via email, as this is often a phishing scheme. Pay is then directly deposited into the employee's checking account within ten days of the end of a pay period.

If you believe an improper deduction has been made to your salary, you should immediately report this information to human resources. If it is determined that an improper deduction has occurred, you will be promptly reimbursed. While every effort will be made by the Company to pay the correct amount within the correct time, you should review your paycheck when received and contact HR if you believe an error has been made.

Modifications to your federal or state withholdings, as well as updating your direct deposit information must be done via Rippling. For security reasons, HR is unable to update bank account information or tax forms.

Time Reporting

All employees must record all time worked daily. The Company requires **all employees** to utilize the current electronic [timecard system](#) to report hours worked. Time should be reported contemporaneously, using the appropriate category and with a description. We will review time spent, in addition to progress on current assignments, during our weekly morning meetings. Time entries should not span more than one day's worth of work, though it is possible to span two calendar days if you are working late, but should not span a pay week. Be extra careful to not have an entry span across two payroll periods. If you are working late on Thursday, you should have one-time card entry that ends before 2:00 a.m. Friday (well before would be best) and another that ends after that. Pay is based on the "end date time" so the first entry would get paid in the first pay week and the later one in the following pay week. No time will be lost or double counted in any event, but if you put all the charge on a line that ends after midnight the whole amount will be paid in the subsequent time period. Pay weeks end at 2:00 a.m. (Mountain Time) on Friday.

It is your responsibility to ensure your total hours according to the time keeping system match your expectations. Discrepancies or questions should be brought to HR as soon as possible to avoid any issues at payroll time.

Off-The-Clock Work

It is a clear violation of labor laws for employees to engage in “off the clock” work, where you are performing work for the benefit of the company and not reporting it for compensation. Ultimately, if this practice is discovered the employer is held liable (so even if you think you are doing the firm a favor to save a few bucks, you are actually opening it to a very large lawsuit liability).

Hourly employees are expressly prohibited from off-the-clock work. Employees found to be misreporting time (either under or over actual worked hours) are subject to discipline up to and including termination.

Overtime

This policy outlines our company's standards for overtime pay, in compliance with the **Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA)** and applicable state laws where we operate.

Under Section 13(a)(1) and Section 13(a)(17), skilled computer workers are generally exempt from overtime pay, as long as they are paid greater than the minimum required hourly rate. There are also exceptions for administrative employees who serve a primary role in directing the administrative functions of the business.

The handling of overtime pay is important for two reasons. First, Semantic Arts must ensure we compensate employees fairly and in accordance with relevant laws. Second, Semantic Arts must ensure that the additional costs of overtime (whether exempt overtime or not) align with business priorities and serve a bona fide business purpose.

Overtime Pay Requirements

Based on the type of employment and job duties for a given role, you are designated as “exempt” or “non-exempt” under the FLSA standards. These are outlined below.

Employee Type	Overtime Pay Requirements
Executive Staff (CEO, Pres, COO)	Exempt from overtime pay
Salaried Administrative Staff	Exempt from overtime pay
Hourly Administrative Staff	Non-exempt from overtime pay
Internal Semantic Developers	Generally exempt from overtime pay, with exceptions
Consultants	Generally exempt from overtime pay, with exceptions

Exceptions are state-specific. For instance:

- In Washington, computer workers must be paid a salary to be exempt from overtime requirements.
- The Colorado COMPS order creates a higher threshold for CO employees.
- In California, employees paid less than \$56.97 are non-exempt from overtime pay.

Based on the above, non-exempt employees are entitled to overtime pay at 1.5x their regular pay rate for all time worked over 40 hours a week. The 40 hours are calculated on worked time, meaning that PTO does not count into the calculation. In California, any hours worked over 8 in a single workday are also counted as overtime and must be paid at the higher rate.

Project managers and supervisors are expected to monitor spending and manage teams appropriately. We also expect employees to make the most of their time, ensuring that all time recorded is being done to benefit and support the firm. All time is subject to review by management, and management reserves the right to limit how employees utilize their time.

Employees living in states with more restrictive regulations, such as those cited above, will be dealt with on a case-by-case basis, and may be subject to additional restrictions on overtime hours.

Travel Time for Non-Exempt Employees

Overnight, Out-of-Town Trips

Non-exempt employees will be compensated for time spent traveling (except for meal periods) during their normal working hours, on days they are scheduled to work and on unscheduled work days (such as weekends). Non-exempt employees also will be paid for any time spent performing job duties during otherwise non-compensable travel time; however, such work should be limited absent advance management authorization.

Out-of-Town Trips for One Day

Non-exempt employees who travel out of town for a one-day assignment will be paid for all travel time, except for, among other things: time spent traveling between the employee's home and the local railroad, bus or plane terminal; and meal periods.

Local Travel

Non-exempt employees will be compensated for time spent traveling from one job site to another job site during a workday. The trip home, however, is non-compensable when the employee goes directly home from the final job site, unless it is much longer than the regular commute home from the regular worksite. In such case, the portion of the trip home in excess of the regular commute is compensable.

Commuting Time

Under the Portal to Portal Act, travel from home to work and from work to home is generally non-compensable. However, if a non-exempt employee regularly reports to a worksite near their home, but is required to report to a worksite farther away than the regular worksite, the additional time spent traveling is compensable.

If compensable travel time results in more than 40 hours worked by a non-exempt employee, the employee will be compensated at an overtime rate of one and one-half (1.5) times the regular rate.

Safe Harbor Policy for Salaried Exempt Employees

It is Semantic Arts' policy and practice to accurately compensate employees and to do so in compliance with all applicable state and federal laws. To ensure proper payment and that no improper deductions are made, employees must review pay stubs promptly to identify and report all errors.

Those classified as exempt salaried employees will receive a salary which is intended to compensate them for all hours they may work for Semantic Arts. This salary will be established at the time of hire or classification as an exempt employee. While it may be subject to review and modification from time to time, such as during salary review times, the salary will be a predetermined amount that will not be subject to deductions for variations in the quantity or quality of the work performed.

Under federal and state law, salary is subject to certain deductions. For example, unless state law requires otherwise, salary can be reduced for the following reasons:

- full-day absences for personal reasons;
- full-day absences for sickness or disability if the deduction is made in accordance with a bona fide plan, policy or practice of providing wage replacement benefits for such absences (deductions also may be made for the exempt employee's full-day absences due to sickness or disability before the employee has qualified for the plan, policy or practice or after the employee has exhausted the leave allowance under the plan);
- full-day disciplinary suspensions for infractions of our written policies and procedures;
- Family and Medical Leave Act absences (either full- or partial-day absences);
- to offset amounts received as payment from the court for jury and witness fees or from the military as military pay;
- the first or last week of employment in the event the employee works less than a full week; and
- any full work week in which the employee does not perform any work.

Salary may also be reduced for certain types of deductions such as a portion of health, dental or life insurance premiums; state, federal or local taxes; social security; or voluntary contributions to a 401(k) or pension plan.

In any work week in which the employee performed any work, salary will not be reduced for any of the following reasons:

- partial day absences for personal reasons, sickness or disability;
- an absence because the Company has decided to close a facility on a scheduled work day;
- absences for jury duty, attendance as a witness, or military leave in any week in which the employee performed any work (subject to any offsets as set forth above); and
- any other deductions prohibited by state or federal law.

However, unless state law provides otherwise, deductions may be made to accrued leave for full- or partial-day absences for personal reasons, sickness or disability.

If employees believe they have been subject to any improper deductions, they should immediately report the matter to a supervisor. If the supervisor is unavailable or if the employee believes it would be inappropriate to contact that person (or if the employee has not received a prompt and fully acceptable reply), they should immediately contact Human Resources or any other supervisor in Semantic Arts with whom the employee feels comfortable.

Benefits

Benefits Overview

Details around Semantic Arts benefit offerings are available on SharePoint, in the public HR folder.

Overall, the Semantic Arts benefit package is designed to provide the most value to our employees while maintaining affordability as a small business. As part of its total compensation strategy, the Company offers different insurance plans for eligible employees. To receive certain benefits, eligible employees may be required to meet participation requirements and pay required premiums and other contributions. Benefits often come with certain tax incentives, such as premiums paid pre-tax thereby reducing your taxable income. The Company complies with all applicable federal and state laws regarding the provision of benefits to same-sex spouses, domestic partners, and couples in a civil union.

Benefit plans offered by the Company are defined in legal documents such as insurance contracts and summary plan descriptions. In the event information in this Handbook or other employee communication conflicts with the actual terms and conditions of

coverage, the plan documents will control. Benefits described in this Handbook, including the types of benefits offered and/or the requirements for eligibility of coverage, may be modified or discontinued from time to time at the Company's discretion as permitted by law. The Company and its designated benefit plan administrators reserve the right to determine eligibility, interpretation and administration of issues related to benefits offered by the Company.

Eligibility

Benefit	Days to Eligibility	Minimum Hours Work Required
401(k) participation & match	Immediately	None
Dental	1st of month following hire date	30 hours per week
Employee Assistance Program	Immediately	None, but must be on our group health plan
Employee Device Purchase Program (BYOD)	Immediately	None
Medical / Vision	1st of month following hire date	30 hours per week
Student Loan Reimbursement	Immediately	None
Training & Learning Fund	Immediately	Specifics to be determined for part-time employees.

Part-Time Employee Benefits

For employees that are not scheduled to work a full-time schedule, benefits are different than those full-time. See below for a breakdown

- 401(k) match up to 4% still available
- Employees scheduled for at least 30 hours per week remain eligible for health insurance coverage
- Sick time is reduced to 3 days per year, can be taken in small increments or not charged if outside of regular working hours
- Vacation is roughly 2 weeks per year in place of 4, but can be adjusted based on supervisor feedback

- Training and learning budget is available, but all expenses must be pre-approved or discussed ahead of time

Health Insurance

Semantic Arts offers a group plan with options from a national provider. We subsidize a large portion of the cost for an employee, as well as some cost for dependents. These plans are shopped and compared annually to available offerings to attempt to offer the best value to our employees. Semantic Arts works hard to stay aware of the current challenges and scams that exist within the health insurance and prescription drug industries while also working with a licensed insurance advisor to ensure high quality, fair plans for employees.

Overall, there are a number of different options that exist for procuring insurance. Given the overall high price of health insurance, we recommend you take the time to look at the various options that exist and make the right decision for you. We are not insurance advisors; all decisions should be made with the support of insurance professionals.

If you need to make any changes to your plan during the plan year due to qualified life events (change in spousal coverage, etc.), then please start by contacting HR. We will open an enrollment option for you to make changes to your plans for a specific window. Please keep in mind many qualified life events have a set amount of time in which to make changes. Failure to notify HR in a timely manner may result in missed opportunities.

Deductions from payroll for insurance contributions will be done over 12 pay periods from January, withholding the estimated yearly cost evenly divided. The last payroll before the new plan period will be used to reconcile the year's payments to match what was actually due to the insurance provider. This means generally there will be no deduction on that 13th payroll. If reconciliation requires additional funds, you will be notified before the payroll is run.

Prescription Drug Coverage

Semantic Arts plans include some coverage for prescription drugs. Many companies utilize what is called a "PBM" to help manage drug coverage with a claim of "lower costs", but due to highly unethical practices this is landing more and more organizations in court and leaving employees with medications sometimes at a 2400% cost increase! We do not use a PBD, and therefore avoid any of these unethical practices.

As an alternative, we recommend whenever purchasing a new medication, you consider the use of a discount card such as GoodRx (<https://www.goodrx.com/>) or even asking about savings for cash pay. By comparing these costs you can often reduce the overall cost of prescription medications.

Time Off Policies

Time off policies are covered in more depth in the “Time Away from Work” section below.

Workers’ Compensation

On-the-job injuries are covered by Semantic Arts’ Workers' Compensation Insurance Policy, which is provided at no cost. If employees are injured on the job, no matter how slightly, they should report the incident immediately to their supervisor. Failure to follow Company procedures may affect the ability of employees to receive Workers Compensation benefits.

This is solely a monetary benefit and not a leave of absence entitlement. Employees who need to miss work due to a workplace injury must also request a formal leave of absence. See the Leave of Absence sections of this handbook for more information.

Employee Assistance Program

The EAP is available to all employees enrolled in our health plan. This provides employees and their families with information and assistance on a wide range of topics and issues including work stress, debt problems, family issues, relationship worries, parenting challenges, anxiety, grief, and much more.

The program includes up to six in-person or online counseling sessions at no cost, and help to navigate any longer-term needs. This is available 24 hours a day, 7 days a week. More information can be found in the Benefits Book on SharePoint.

Health Savings Account

For employees with H.S.A. approved plans (either obtained through the company or individually), we can withhold H.S.A. contributions from payroll pre-tax and deposit into an individual H.S.A. account. This account must be opened with our approved bank.

Dental, Vision, Disability Insurance Plans

The company offers dental and vision insurance, as well as a few disability plans. Details are in the benefits book on SharePoint.

401(k) Retirement Program

Offered through Human Interest, Semantic Arts has a group 401(k) plan and provides up to a 4% match on employee contributions. Employees pick the fund allocations and control their account and maintain control even after separation from the company. There is no vesting or contribution limits outside of required IRS regulations. Employees will be

automatically enrolled upon hire unless indicating otherwise. Upon separation from the company, you retain control of this account to either continue to contribute or rollover.

Student Loan Reimbursement

The company will provide matching funds for the repayment of student loans up to \$100 per month.

To qualify, the employee should provide proof of payment (receipts, canceled checks, etc.) of a maximum of \$100/month up to the number of months employed that year, by December 1st. The Company will compensate the employee a matching amount in the last pay period of the year.

If you wish to participate in this program, please fill out the form available from HR and submit the form and proof of payment.

Note: If the employee's start date falls before the 15th of the month they start, it counts as a full month. If they start after the 15th, the count does not begin until the following month.

Technology Upgrades (BYOD)

In order to make it easier for our employees to have the necessary devices to excel in their positions, we will buy a computer (laptop or desktop) on the employee's behalf with a few provisions. Further details can be found on Confluence. If you wish to participate in this program, please fill out the form and submit the form to the Office Manager.

Office Supply Allowance

Given the company's commitment to remote-first employment, we want to support employees in maintaining a productive work environment and to effectively perform job duties outside of a corporate office.

Details can be found on Confluence in the Company Reference Guide.

Employee Development Benefits

Semantic Arts believes strongly in investing time and resources into our employees. This includes \$3,000 set aside annually for an employee's self-directed skill development. Expenses must be pre-approved, but can often be used for classes, conferences, books, and more. In addition, those who choose to present either virtually or in-person on topics related to semantic technology are given additional budget into their fund, for use in further education or paid out as a bonus at the end of the year (subject to policy constraints).

Further details can be found on Confluence in the Company Reference Guide.

Semantic Arts Summits

Generally held annually, the team is invited to Fort Collins for an expense paid company summit. This summit represents a time of development, relationship building, and fun. Topics are generally selected by the team and are highly discussion driven.

The annual summit is considered a required activity, so employees should make every effort to attend or notify the office ASAP of any conflicts.

Other Training Sessions

We work to bring in speakers often to provide additional training to the team. This is often technical (vendors, applications, research, etc.), but can also be focused on soft skills (presenting, management, etc.). These are free and open to all to attend. If you have suggestions or ideas for future trainings, please let the office manager know.

Time Away From Work

Paid Time Off (PTO)

Paid time off is not considered a form of additional wages, but part of the Company's commitment to employee health and flexibility. Semantic Arts encourages the use of paid vacation time to recharge and avoid burnout. In order to promote this, we have a flexible paid vacation policy. Full time employees may schedule and take PTO as you like, subject to management approval. You should also be sensitive to project deadlines and meetings as it relates to your time off, along with communicating clearly with others on the team to ensure tasks and responsibilities are accounted for.

This is not one of those "unlimited" vacation policies that are well intentioned and yet lead to employees actually using less vacation time out of fear of job security. We would encourage employees to aim for approximately 4 weeks of vacation per year. We will run a query on a monthly basis to review vacation time utilized and make recommendations as appropriate. This query will run over the past 18 pay periods and look for roughly 6 weeks of vacation over that time. The reason for the longer lookback is to account for spikes due to longer trips and end of the year travel.

The intent of time off is to re-charge your batteries, therefore we encourage you to take it in full day increments when you are not also working. In general, you should charge a full day's worth of hours of PTO on a scheduled day off and no hours of work. There can be exceptions when you start PTO at mid-day, but these should be the exception. Employees should not work during their PTO.

When you schedule PTO, we ask that you commit to returning for at least as long as your vacation (e.g., if you schedule a six-week vacation, you are expected to return to work for at least six weeks after the vacation).

Because this is not an accrual-based policy, no PTO will be paid out upon separation from the company.

In the normal course of business, we will not be approving (or not approving) requests for time off. We expect you will make sure to cover any required duties between others on your projects, clients, and any other obligations.

Notification of upcoming time off is completed via the procedure found in the Employee Reference Guide.

If we detect a pattern of excessive time off, you will be sent an email requesting you curtail your PTO for a season of time.

Sick Time

We understand that unexpected absences happen, thus employees are granted a maximum of 6 days (48 hours) of sick time per calendar year. This time does not accrue year over year. Employees should use this time if they are ill or need to take an unexpected absence, or for planned medical appointments, etc. This time is available effective your first day of employment.

Please note your sick leave can be used for any reason covered under the Healthy Families and Workplaces Act ([Paid Sick Leave under the Colorado Healthy Families and Workplaces Act \(HFWA\) | Department of Labor & Employment](#)), no matter what state you may reside in. If your resident state has a Paid Sick Time policy, any additional covered reasons for leave also apply.

Employees should take no less than hourly increments of sick time and are expected to make the appropriate channels aware of their absence. No-call-no-shows and other abuse of this policy will be addressed on a case-to-case basis. You may be required to provide proof of your illness.

Holidays

The office will be closed, and employees will be paid for the following 8 federal holidays:

- New Year's Day
- Memorial Day
- Independence Day
- Labor Day

- Thanksgiving Day & Friday after Thanksgiving
- Christmas Eve Day & Christmas Day

Please note, employees are free to modify these holidays to fit your circumstances, as long as no more than 8 holidays are taken paid per year. For example, those residing in Canada may choose to forego the Independence Day holiday and instead apply that day to a local holiday.

Generally, a holiday that falls on a Saturday will be observed on the Friday previous, and those falling on a Sunday will be observed the following Monday. Specific notices about holidays will be emailed by the office as needed.

You should utilize the appropriate holiday entry in the timecard system to document these dates.

Bereavement

Full-time employees are eligible for leave due to the death of either an immediate or extended family member and related activities. You are permitted to utilize either sick time or PTO to cover your absence during these times or may choose to take leave unpaid. Be sure to communicate your absence through the usual channels and with those required to cover your duties while you are away.

Should you need any additional resources, the EAP (mentioned in the benefits section) is available for counseling related to mental health, financial health, and more. Contact HR for further information if needed.

Jury Duty

Semantic Arts realizes that it is the obligation of all U.S. citizens to serve on a jury when summoned to do so. All employees will be allowed time off to perform such civic service as required by law. Employees are expected, however, to provide proper notice of a request to perform jury duty and verification of their service.

Employees also are expected to keep management informed of the expected length of jury duty service and to report to work for the major portion of the day if excused by the court. If the required absence presents a serious conflict for management, employees may be asked to try to postpone jury duty.

Employees on jury duty leave will be paid for their jury duty service in accordance with state law; however, exempt employees will be paid their full salary for any week in which time is missed due to jury duty if work is performed for the Company during such week.

Witness Service

In the event you receive a subpoena to testify, assist, or participate in any court proceeding or administrative proceeding (e.g., the Equal Employment Opportunity Commission, Fair Employment and Housing Commission, National Labor Relations Board, etc.), the Company will approve unpaid leave for you to fulfill such civic obligations.

You are required to provide a copy of the subpoena or other notice of the court or other proceeding to the Company as far in advance as possible so that appropriate scheduling adjustments may be made.

Exempt employees may be required to provide documentation of any amounts paid to the employee by a court, subpoenaing party, or other source for fulfilling the duty, because amounts equal to such payments received may be deducted from the employee's salary, consistent with applicable law. Civic Duty Leave is unpaid for non-exempt employees, and they are not required to report to the Company any payments that they may receive.

Voting

Voting is an important responsibility we all assume as citizens. We encourage employees to exercise their voting rights in all municipal, state, and federal elections.

Under most circumstances, it is possible for employees to vote either before or after work. If it is necessary for employees to arrive late or leave work early to vote in any election, employees should arrange with their supervisor/manager no later than the day prior to Election Day.

Leaves of Absence

Parental Leave

There are two types of leave available related to parental leave, paid and unpaid.

Full-time company employees are eligible for two weeks of paid leave specifically related to the birth or adoption of a child (both parents) in addition to the guidelines provided for PTO. This leave does not need to be taken consecutively.

For extended leave beyond these two weeks, the Company may be able to provide additional unpaid leave, as long as such leave does not create an undue burden on the Company. Such leave may be required based on the employee's state of residence, and as such we will comply with any applicable laws. Depending on your state of residence, there may be compensation available through a state Family Leave program. Please contact HR if you have any questions about this.

Medical Leave

An unpaid medical leave of absence of not more than 12 weeks **may** currently be granted to full-time employees. This unpaid leave is intended to cover any absences arising from illness, injury, or caregiving.

Medical Leave **may** be granted if each of the following conditions is met:

- The employee has completed at least ninety (90) days of employment with our Company.
- Human Resources is notified as soon as possible by the employee of the need for medical leave.
- The employee submits to Human Resources a completed leave of absence form and/or a written statement from the healthcare provider outlining the reason for leave and the estimated time needed. (The Company reserves the right to obtain a Company healthcare provider's opinion.)
- Approvals are obtained from the President, prior to the leave.

When the estimated period of leave is less than 12 weeks, and an employee needs to extend the leave, another healthcare provider's statement is required indicating the new estimated length of leave.

An employee ready to return to work from leave must present a healthcare provider's statement indicating ability to return to work, and if any restrictions may apply.

The Company may reinstate an employee ready to return from a medical leave of absence when, in the opinion of the Company, it is practical to do so. The Company does not guarantee reinstatement of an employee to the former job. When the employee is available to return to work, the employee is free to apply for any vacancy available and may be considered along with other applicants.

The Company currently continues medical insurance benefits for an employee on leave for a maximum of 12 weeks if the employee continues to pay the employee's portion of the premium.

Holiday pay and jury duty pay will not be granted during the leave.

Employees who fail to return at the expiration of their authorized leave may be terminated. If the employee's failure to return is due to a disability under the Americans with Disabilities Act or other law, additional accommodations may be provided. Employees must supply enough information from their healthcare provider indicating that they have a covered disability and indicate when they can return to work with or without reasonable accommodation.

Accommodations must not cause undue hardship to the employer. Potential accommodations will be determined in an interactive process between the employee and the Company.

Part-time employees are not eligible for medical leave except as required by law.

Military Leave

Employees granted a military leave of absence are reinstated and paid in accordance with the laws governing veterans' re-employment rights.

Other Leave

There are various other reasons an employee may desire a leave of absence. In some cases these are governed by state or federal law, and the Company is committed to compliance with these requirements. In other cases, there may be a need or desire by the employee to take an extended leave. This should be discussed with HR or the President and are approved on a case-by-case basis.

General Standards of Conduct

Code of Conduct

Overview

At Semantic Arts we require that all of our employees conduct themselves according to the highest standards of ethics, integrity, and behavior when dealing with our clients, colleagues and other stakeholders. This includes, but is not necessarily limited to, full compliance with all legal obligations imposed by statute or any other source of law.

This Code establishes the standards of behavior that must be met by all employees. Where these standards are not met, appropriate disciplinary action will be taken. In cases where the breach involves serious misconduct, this may result in summary dismissal. In cases where a breach of the policy involves a breach of any law, then the relevant government authorities or the police may be notified.

Operation

The purpose of this policy is to make it clear what the Company expects from employees, and employees are required to be familiar with and comply with the terms of this policy at all times. Failure to do so may result in disciplinary action, including potentially termination of employment.

In so far as this policy imposes any obligations on the Company, those obligations are not contractual and do not give rise to any contractual rights. To the extent that this policy describes benefits and entitlements for employees, they are discretionary in nature and are also not intended to be contractual. They set the terms and conditions of employment that are intended to be contractual out in an employee's written employment contract.

The Company may unilaterally introduce, vary, remove or replace this policy at any time.

Standards of Conduct

The standards expected of employees include:

- Compliance with all Company and workplace policies, procedures, rules, regulations and contracts;
- Compliance with all laws;
- Compliance with all reasonable and lawful instructions given by or on behalf of the Company;
- Devotion of the employee's entire time, attention and skill during working hours and at other times as reasonably necessary for the employee to perform their duties;
- To be honest and fair in dealings with customers, clients, co-workers, Company management and the general public, and to treat them with courtesy and respect;
- To be faithful and diligent, and actively pursue the Company's best interests at all times;
- To work in a safe and compliant manner, and to observe all workplace health and safety rules and responsibilities;
 - Refraining from any discriminatory, bullying or harassing behavior toward customers, clients, co-workers, Company management and the general public;
- To not make any statements to the media about the Company's business, unless expressly authorized to do so by the Company (requests for media statements should be referred to Business Development);
- To not, in connection with the employee's employment, accept any financial or other benefit from any entity other than the Company – unless acceptance of such benefit is in accordance with the Company's other workplace policies or is otherwise disclosed to the Company and expressly permitted by the Company;
- To abide by the terms and requirements of the Employment Agreement and CIAA policies set forth;
- To not use, or come to work while affected by use of prohibited drugs or alcohol;
- To not discriminate on the basis of personal characteristics including (but not limited to) sex, race, disability, pregnancy, age, marital status or sexual orientation;
- To ensure and maintain punctuality;
- To respect the Company's property;
- At all times, behave in a way that upholds the Company's core values and the integrity and good reputation of the Company;

- Reporting any conduct of other workplace participants which is in breach of any of the above, or potentially in breach of any of the above, without delay.

Use of Social Media

Semantic Arts respects the right of any employee to maintain a blog or web page or to participate in a social networking on or through websites or services such as X (formerly Twitter), Facebook, Threads, LinkedIn, YouTube, Instagram, TikTok, Snapchat, or similar sites/services (collectively "social media"). However, to protect Company interests and ensure employees focus on their job duties, employees must adhere to the following rules:

Employees may not use social media during work time or at any time with Company equipment or property unless directly related to business function.

All rules regarding confidential and proprietary business information apply in full to social media. Any information that cannot be disclosed through a conversation, a note, or an e-mail also cannot be disclosed through social media.

When using social media, the employee should not mention the Company and also expresses either a political opinion or an opinion regarding the Company's actions that could pose an actual or potential conflict of interest with the Company, and it is either implicit or explicit that the poster is affiliated with the Company.

Employees may not use the Company's logos or trademarks for commercial purposes or to endorse any product or service.

Any conduct that is impermissible under the law if expressed in any other form or forum is impermissible if expressed through social media. For example, posted material that is discriminatory, obscene, defamatory, libelous, or violent is forbidden. Company policies apply equally to employee social media usage.

Employees with any questions should review the guidelines above and/or consult with their manager. Failure to follow these guidelines may result in discipline, up to and including discharge.

Dress Code

As a professional services consultancy, it is necessary to project an image of professionalism in interactions with clients and other external stakeholders.

When interacting with a client, you must be dressed in appropriate business attire. Generally, attire should be clean, pressed, wrinkle-free and never sloppy. A bit more specifically when in-person:

Required dress for **men** would include slacks with a blazer or suit; a button-down shirt; and dress shoes. A tie can be added if you feel it is appropriate for the particular meeting or client.

Required dress for **women** would include blouses and button-down tops; skirts, dresses or pants; and a blazer or sweater. Tops and dresses should generally have sleeves, but can be sleeveless with a blazer or sweater on top. Skirts and dresses should generally fall at or below the knee (not short).

One key specific for both genders is that some type of jacket/sweater is a requirement when in-person. Though you may remove it during a particular meeting, you will find many professional organizations where employees are required to wear a jacket, and you should never be the most casually dressed person in attendance (though it's not bad to be the most professionally dressed).

Some good examples can be found here: [Guide To Business Attire \(With Examples\) | Indeed.com](#). Generally, these requirements align with "Business Professional," and you may find the comparison with the other styles shown helpful.

Employees not conforming to this dress code may be asked to leave a meeting until they can return in appropriate attire.

Virtually, there is room for a bit more flexibility, though with awareness as to the nature of the client relationship and the position of those with whom you are meeting (i.e. company president, other executive leadership, etc.). When in doubt, dress more formally than you think is necessary. A T-Shirt is never acceptable. A shirt with a collar or appropriate blouse would be the minimum standard, regardless of what the client may choose to wear.

Outside of client interactions, such as meetings with those outside Semantic Arts, you should be mindful of the image you are projecting and dress accordingly. Choosing to dress nicely validates our professionalism and expertise to others (and often psychologically to yourself) and can be fun in the era of remote work!

If you are unsure of the proper dress code for a particular meeting or client, please speak with the senior ontologist on the project, or HR.

Confidential Information/Intellectual Property

Employees of the Company will have access to confidential information about the Company and our clients. Confidential information includes, but is not limited to, trade secrets, business practices, and processes, intellectual property (developed while employed at the Company), and similar subjects.

Disclosure of confidential information might seriously damage the Company's or a client's competitive position; therefore, such action will not be tolerated. This non-disclosure applies during and after an employee's employment. Any copying, reproducing, or distributing of confidential information in any manner must be authorized by management. Confidential information remains the property of the employer and must be returned to the Company on demand.

What you create while you are with Semantic Arts is the property of Semantic Arts. This includes copyright for what you write, and potentially patents for any inventions created while you are employed here. What you learn (your knowledge) is yours to keep. What you reduced to deliverables belongs to us or our clients, depending on the arrangement.

Employees are prohibited from purchasing or selling securities based on information not available to the public.

For more information on this policy, please see the agreements you signed in Rippling or contact HR.

Conflict of Interest

Semantic Arts, Inc. requires that employees protect Company information and avoid outside activities or relationships that do or could adversely influence their decisions or actions on the job.

Conflict of interest situations, which could arise while moonlighting for a competitor of ours, should also be avoided.

Other examples of conflict of interest include but are not limited to, serving as a board member or director of a competing firm, holding a financial interest in a competing Company, being self-employed in an occupation that competes with the Company, or ownership, partnership, or personal involvement in supplier companies or distribution outlets related to Company business.

If employees have any questions about whether a situation is a conflict of interest, they should discuss the matter with their supervisor. If it remains unresolved, refer the matter to the President of the Company for a final determination.

For more information on this policy, please see the agreements you signed in Rippling or contact HR.

Workplace Health

Generally speaking, employees are encouraged to take proper precautions to both care for themselves and prevent the spread of illness. The Company encourages employees to stay

home when not feeling well and follow recommended health guidelines when dealing with any illness. Sick Time is provided for employees to use due to illness or unexpected absence.

Employees are also expected to follow any protocols related to illness set forth by a client while on-site.

Inspections

We reserve the right to conduct searches and inspections of any employee or Company-owned property without notice consistent with applicable law. A Company-initiated search does not necessarily imply an accusation of theft or that an employee has broken a rule. Any employee who refuses to submit to such a search will be subject to disciplinary action up to and including termination.

Safety/Reporting Of Injury

The Company is committed to a safe work environment for employees. Employees should report any unsafe practices or conditions to their supervisor immediately.

If employees (remote or otherwise) are injured on the job and plan to seek medical attention, they must immediately report this fact in writing to the owner/manager.

If medical treatment for an on-the-job injury is needed, it must be obtained from one of the Company's designated physicians. If not, the employee may be responsible for the cost of medical treatment.

Hiring Relatives/Employee Relationships

A familial relationship among employees can create an actual or at least a potential conflict of interest in the employment setting, especially where one relative supervises another relative. To avoid this problem, Semantic Arts may refuse to hire or place a relative in a position where the potential for favoritism or conflict exists.

In other cases, such as personal relationships where a conflict or the potential for conflict arises, even if there is no supervisory relationship involved, the parties may be separated by reassignment or discharged from employment, at the discretion of the Company. Accordingly, all parties to any type of intimate personal relationship must inform management.

If two employees marry, become related, or enter into an intimate relationship, they may not remain in a reporting relationship or in positions where one individual may affect the compensation or other terms or conditions of employment of the other individual. The Company generally will attempt to identify other available positions, but if no alternate

position is available, the Company retains the right to decide which employee will remain with the Company.

For the purposes of this policy, a relative is any person who is related by blood or marriage, or whose relationship with the employee is similar to that of persons who are related by blood or marriage.

Business Expense Reimbursement

Employees will be reimbursed for reasonable approved expenses incurred in the course of business. These expenses must be approved by the COO or president, and may include air travel, hotels, motels, meals, cab fare, rental vehicles, or gas and car mileage for personal vehicles. All expenses incurred should be submitted to the office along with the receipts in a timely manner.

Employees are expected to exercise restraint and good judgment when incurring expenses. Employees should contact the COO in advance if they have any questions about whether an expense will be reimbursed.

Employment Verification

When provided with a signed and dated Release Form from a current or former employee, the Company will verify employment and release requested information. If employees receive a call or email inquiring about a current or former employee, please refer the call or email to the office. Only the COO has the authority to respond to such inquiries.

Discipline/Discharge

Occasionally, performance or other behavior falls short of our standards and/or expectations. When this occurs, management will take action that, in its opinion, seems appropriate.

Disciplinary actions can range from a formal discussion with the employee about the matter to immediate discharge. Action taken by management in an individual case does not establish a precedent in other circumstances.

Separation of Employment

If you desire to end your employment relationship with the Company, we ask that you notify us as soon as possible of the intended separation. The notice allows enough time to transfer work, cover shifts, return Company property, review eligibility for continuation of insurance, and arrange for your final pay. Employees separating voluntarily from the company will be paid their final paycheck at the next regularly scheduled payroll interval.

At time of separation, HR will contact you to schedule an exit interview. You are also responsible for returning all company property. This could include a device still covered under the BYOD policy, as well as any documents or files stored locally on your computer instead of the company's file system. You are not permitted to download or save any company files for use after your separation, with the exception of a few HR related documents. Please speak with HR should you have any questions.

Also note our PTO policy requires that an employee return from any approved PTO for at least as long as they were out.

Employees who plan to retire are asked to provide enough advance notice to the Company so we can timely process any pension forms or other retirement benefits to which an employee may be entitled.

Electronic Equipment and IT Policies

Use of Facilities, Equipment and Property, Including Intellectual Property

Equipment essential in accomplishing job duties is often expensive and may be difficult to replace. When using property, employees are expected to exercise care, perform required maintenance, and follow all operating instructions, safety standards and guidelines.

Employees also are prohibited from any unauthorized use of the Company's intellectual property, such as audio and video tapes, print materials and software.

Improper, careless, negligent, destructive, or unsafe use or operation of equipment can result in discipline, up to and including discharge.

Data Disposal Policy

During your employment, the Company will collect certain information that is classified as "personal identifying information," or PII, under applicable laws. Such information may include, but is not limited to:

- Your first and last name or initials.
- Username(s) and password(s).
- Social security number.
- Driver license or other identification card number.
- Medical documentation.
- Biometric data.
- And more.

The Company may keep these records in paper and/or electronic format.

When such documentation is no longer needed, pursuant to records retention requirements and best practices, the Company will either (a) destroy the records or (b) arrange for their destruction, e.g. by shredding, erasing, or otherwise modifying the personal identifying information in such a manner as to render it unreadable or indecipherable through any means.

Communication Systems

The communication and information systems are property of the Company and intended for business use. An employee's use of these systems must not disrupt the operation of the Company network or the networks of other users. Moreover, it must not interfere with employees' productivity. Personal use of the internet must be kept to a minimum.

The Company maintains the ability to access any computer files, use of software, Internet usage, e-mail, and voice mail on company systems. Although employees may select individual passwords, employees should not assume that such files are confidential. However, other than management employees acting on behalf of the Company, employees should not attempt to gain access to another employee's computer, Internet files, e-mail, or voice mail without the latter's permission.

All information regarding access to the Company's computer resources, such as user identifications, modem phone numbers, access codes, and passwords is Company confidential information and may not be disclosed to non-Company personnel.

Employees are expected to have access to a computer suitable for doing their work. We encourage personnel to have the appropriate equipment to do their jobs efficiently. In the event the employee needs to purchase a laptop or phone to perform their job appropriately, the employee can request the Company buy the device on behalf of the employee, by filling out our Device Request Form, (see our stand-alone Employee Device Purchase Request form) authorizing the following:

- The Company will provide software licenses for programs necessary for the execution of the employee's duties. The employee will forfeit these licenses upon resignation or termination.
- The Company reserves the right to remove any information from the employee's computer that the Company perceives as proprietary information, or intellectual property.
- The Company reserves the right to perform a security audit of the employee's device at any time.

Software and Copyright

The Company licenses and does not own most of the software it utilizes. Therefore, use of the software must be in accordance with the applicable Software Agreements or as directed by the Company.

Employees must not use the Company's technology resources to copy, retrieve, forward, or send copyrighted materials unless the employee has the author's permission.

E-mail

Because the Company provides the e-mail system to employees to help them with the performance of their job, it should be used for official Company business. Incidental and occasional personal use of e-mail is permitted; however, employees should be aware that these messages will be treated the same as business messages, and subject to review at any time without notice. Also, employees cannot control where their messages will end up. For example, a message meant for one person can be mistakenly sent to the wrong individual(s), or the message can be forwarded to unintended recipients. In addition, e-mails that were deleted are stored elsewhere on the system may be recovered/shared with other parties.

Employees should use discretion when sending e-mails. Do not write anything in an e-mail message that is inappropriate to say to others face-to-face.

The Company prohibits the display, transmittal, or downloading of material that is offensive, pornographic, obscene, profane, discriminatory, harassing, insulting, derogatory, or otherwise unlawful at any time. No one may solicit, promote, or advertise any outside organization, product, or service using e-mail or anywhere else on Company premises during working time. Working time does not include breaks or meal periods. Management may monitor e-mail from time to time.

Employees are prohibited from unauthorized use of encryption keys or the passwords of other employees to gain access to another employee's e-mail messages.

Telephones

In the interest of good business practice, personal telephone calls, including those made with cell phones and mobile devices, must be minimal and not interfere with employees' performance of their jobs.

For safety reasons, employees should avoid the use of cell phones while driving. Employees are not permitted to text while operating a motor vehicle and can only text when the vehicle is at rest in the shoulder lane or lawfully parked.

It is assumed that employees will use their own cell phones during their jobs. The Company does not provide reimbursement for cell phone usage or contribute to cell phone

plans. Employees should ensure their voicemail greeting is professional and checked on a consistent basis in case of work-related contact.

The Company **does not** have an “always on” policy. Unless a short-term exception is made for a specific project, there is no expectation that employees will return phone calls, emails, or texts from the end of one working day to the beginning of the next, or on the weekends. The general expectation is that communications are returned within 1 business day.

Personal Computers

All employees will utilize their own computer for Semantic Arts related work. You may also be issued a client laptop for some projects, which should be used in accordance with client policies.

Personal computers must:

1. Have an encrypted hard drive
2. Have installed and running anti-virus with a scan frequency of at least monthly
3. Have a system for regular backups of local data, either to an external drive or in the cloud.
4. Have some sort of login credentials required (fingerprint, passcode, etc.)
5. Be kept up to date with latest update package on OS and applications
6. Enable “Find My” services to locate and lock/unlock your device

The use of a password management system is encouraged, but you should also set up the program to require authentication on a frequent basis. This helps to prevent unauthorized access into your password management system.

File Storage

Generally, all Semantic Arts files must be stored on approved systems, which include local servers, SharePoint, Confluence, GitHub, the Shared Folders, and a few others. Local work files must be stored on an encrypted hard drive and should be uploaded into SA file structures as frequently as is feasible.

Employees should generally avoid storing information in file systems outside of those approved by the company. This may be necessary at times but should be done with consideration for the security protocols of the system in question and whether or not the same goal can be accomplished within the Semantic Arts systems.

Potential Breaches

Any employee who believes their computer has been compromised, lost or stolen must report to the Company immediately to protect system access. We will begin to “lock out” systems access and change passwords, as well as monitor for any breach of company information.

IMPORTANT INFORMATION ABOUT THE EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

THIS HANDBOOK AND ANY APPLICABLE STATE SUPPLEMENT IS DESIGNED TO ACQUAINT EMPLOYEES WITH SEMANTIC ARTS, INC. (HEREAFTER, “SEMANTIC ARTS” OR THE “COMPANY”), AND TO PROVIDE SOME INFORMATION ABOUT WORKING HERE.

SEMANTIC ARTS, INC. COMPLIES WITH APPLICABLE STATE AND LOCAL LAWS. SHOULD A GUIDELINE IN THIS HANDBOOK CONFLICT WITH AN APPLICABLE LOCAL, STATE, OR FEDERAL REGULATION OR LAW, THE APPLICABLE REGULATION OR LAW WILL APPLY.

THE HANDBOOK IS NOT ALL-INCLUSIVE, BUT IT IS INTENDED TO PROVIDE EMPLOYEES WITH A SUMMARY OF SOME OF THE COMPANY’S GUIDELINES. THIS EDITION SUPERSEDES AND REPLACES ALL PREVIOUSLY ISSUED EDITIONS AND ANY INCONSISTENT VERBAL OR WRITTEN POLICY STATEMENTS ISSUED PRIOR TO THIS HANDBOOK.

EXCEPT AS MAY BE REQUIRED BY STATE LAW, EMPLOYMENT WITH SEMANTIC ARTS, INC. IS AT-WILL. EMPLOYEES HAVE THE RIGHT TO END THEIR WORK RELATIONSHIP WITH THE COMPANY, WITH OR WITHOUT ADVANCE NOTICE FOR ANY REASON. THE COMPANY HAS THE SAME RIGHT. THE LANGUAGE USED IN THIS HANDBOOK AND ANY VERBAL STATEMENTS MADE BY MANAGEMENT ARE NOT INTENDED TO CONSTITUTE A CONTRACT OF EMPLOYMENT, EITHER EXPRESS OR IMPLIED; NOR ARE THEY A GUARANTEE OF EMPLOYMENT FOR A SPECIFIC DURATION. NO REPRESENTATIVE OF SEMANTIC ARTS, INC., OTHER THAN THE PRESIDENT, HAS THE AUTHORITY TO ENTER INTO AN AGREEMENT OF EMPLOYMENT FOR ANY SPECIFIED PERIOD AND SUCH AGREEMENT MUST BE IN WRITING, SIGNED BY THE PRESIDENT AND THE EMPLOYEE.

NO EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK CAN ANTICIPATE EVERY CIRCUMSTANCE OR QUESTION. AFTER READING THIS HANDBOOK, EMPLOYEES WHO HAVE QUESTIONS SHOULD TALK WITH THEIR IMMEDIATE SUPERVISOR OR THE HUMAN RESOURCES DEPARTMENT. IN ADDITION, THE NEED MAY ARISE TO CHANGE THE GUIDELINES DESCRIBED IN THE HANDBOOK AND ANY APPLICABLE STATE SUPPLEMENT. EXCEPT FOR THE AT-WILL NATURE OF THE EMPLOYMENT, THE COMPANY RESERVES THE RIGHT TO MAKE SUCH CHANGES WITH OR WITHOUT PRIOR NOTICE. NO ORAL STATEMENTS OR REPRESENTATIONS CAN CHANGE THE PROVISIONS OF THIS EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK.

General Handbook Acknowledgement

This Employee Handbook is an important document intended to help employees become acquainted with Semantic Arts. This document is intended to provide guidelines and general descriptions only; it is not the final word in all cases. Individual circumstances may call for individual attention.

Because the Company's operations may change, the contents of this Handbook may be changed at any time, with or without notice, in an individual case or generally, at the sole discretion of management.

Please read the following statements and sign below to indicate your receipt and acknowledgment of this Handbook.

I have received and read a copy of Semantic Arts's Employees Handbook. I understand that the policies, rules and benefits described in it are subject to change at the sole discretion of the Company at any time.

I further understand that my employment is terminable at will, either by myself or the Company, with or without cause or notice, regardless of the length of my employment or the granting of benefits of any kind.

I understand that no representative of Semantic Arts other than the President may alter "at will" status and any such modification must be in a signed writing.

I understand that my signature below indicates that I have read and understand the above statements and that I have received a copy of the Company's Employee Handbook.

Employee's Printed Name: _____

Employee's Signature: _____

Position: _____

Date: _____

The signed original copy of this acknowledgment should be given to management - it will be filed in your personnel file.

STATE AND FEDERAL POSTERS

Because the Company has employees that work entirely remotely without local offices, posting of the federal and state required labor posters can be completed electronically. Please note the required posters are listed below along with the location for viewing. Should you discover a broken link or have questions, please contact hr@semanticarts.com.

Federally Required Posters

- Employee Rights Under Fair Labor Standards Act: [Fair Labor Standards Act \(FLSA\) Minimum Wage Poster | U.S. Department of Labor \(dol.gov\)](#)
- OSHA Job Safety and Health: [OSHA's Free Workplace Poster | Occupational Safety and Health Administration](#)
- Employee Rights and Responsibilities under FMLA: [Employee Rights Under the Family and Medical Leave Act \(dol.gov\)](#)
- E-Verify: [E-Verify Participation Poster English and Spanish](#)
- Equal Employment Opportunity is the Law: [eeopost.pdf \(dol.gov\)](#)
- Employee Polygraph Protection Act: [elaws - <i>FirstStep</i> Poster Advisor \(dol.gov\)](#)
- Your Rights Under USERRA: [Your Rights Under USERRA \(dol.gov\)](#)

State Required Posters

- Alabama: [Alabama Department of Labor](#)
- Arkansas: [Required Postings » Arkansas Department of Labor and Licensing](#)
- California: [California Department of Industrial Relations - Workplace Postings](#)
- Colorado: [Posters | Department of Labor & Employment \(colorado.gov\)](#)
- Florida: [Display Posters and Required Notices - FloridaJobs.org](#)
- Idaho: [Required Posters | Idaho Department of Labor](#)
- Illinois: [Required Posters & Disclosures - Employers \(illinois.gov\)](#)
- Massachusetts: [Massachusetts workplace poster requirements | Mass.gov](#)
- Michigan: [Free Michigan Labor Law Posters for 2022 \(laborposters.org\)](#)
- Minnesota: [Workplace posters | Minnesota Department of Labor and Industry \(mn.gov\)](#)
- Missouri: [Mandatory Posters/Notices | Missouri labor \(mo.gov\)](#)
- New Jersey: [Wage and Hour Compliance | Employer Poster Packet \(nj.gov\)](#)
- New York: [Posting Requirements | Department of Labor \(ny.gov\)](#)
- Ohio: [Posters | Ohio Department of Commerce](#)
- Pennsylvania: [Mandatory Postings \(pa.gov\)](#)
- Texas: [Posters for the Workplace - Texas Workforce Commission](#)
- Virginia: [DOLI Required Posters \(virginia.gov\)](#)
- Washington: [Required Workplace Posters \(wa.gov\)](#)

SIGNATURE, ACKNOWLEDGMENT AND AGREEMENT

I acknowledge that I have received, read, and understand this Confidentiality and Conflict of Interest Agreement, and I agree to abide by its terms.